he'd do if he discovered that she'd lied to him about André.

She felt a stab of guilt at the lie. It had come so quickly from her mouth that she hadn't had time to think it through. Why *had* she lied? If Reinhardt knew André was the man she loved, then Rose would lose all power over him. And it felt good to finally have some control, to direct what happened to her and those she loved rather than being helpless and letting others determine her fate. She needed to be strong. How else could she stand in his office, listening to him, and when he asked, wrapping her arms around him, if she had no power? She needed to believe that her meetings with Reinhardt were some sort of buoy, like a lifeline—a way for her to protect Léa, André and Josef.

But doubts stirred at the back of her mind. She tried to quiet them. If Reinhardt had any intention of pushing himself on her, as Léa intimated when she talked about consequences, then he would have done it already.

Rose had no regrets. Now that she'd set off on this path, she had to continue; the only way forward was through. She couldn't turn around and go back. She believed there was a purpose behind everything, something like a secret hand steering her, though she didn't understand how to explain it. She'd never shared this with Léa, lacking the words to articulate it. But she felt it when she drew, a sense of purpose and direction that guided her hand, creating something out of nothing.

Later, as she walked to the factory, she noticed the sky was the color of the blue dress her mother had made and she'd worn on her date to the cinema with André. A ripple of reassurance passed through Rose. It had to be a sign sent from Maman, telling her she was on the right path.

The morning shift stretched by slowly. Rose checked the wall clock, willing the minutes to pass quicker. At lunch, she went to the canteen, hoping she'd find André sitting at the table with the French flag among the former prisoners of war, whom she did her best to avoid because they were so quick to judge her, and remembering their anger made her shudder to think what would happen after she returned to France. But André wasn't there. And it was silly to think that he would be assigned to her factory. There were many factories in town. It was the not knowing that made her crazy. Rose went outside and walked along the road up to the station. Near a parked train, soldiers escorted women from the carriages to the white tent at the far end of the platform. She glimpsed Léa and wished she could go